

To begin working with wood, it's essential to understand how wood behaves. Wood is a composite of lignin and cellulose fibres. While the lignin gives wood its rigidity, the cellulose fibres give wood its tensile strength.

Types of wood

Wood can be broadly classified into hardwoods and softwoods. While hardwoods are typically denser, softwoods are not as much. Hardwood is harvested from trees that take more time to mature compared to softwood and is typically more expensive as a result.

Indian Hardwoods include Oak, Sal and Rosewood, while softwoods include Pine, Deodar and Red Cedar. Interestingly, Teak, prized for its durability is in fact falls somewhere in between.

Apart from natural woods, there are also composite woods to consider while deciding to embark on a project. Two of the most common composites are plywood and particleboard. Plywood is made by layering wood veneer—thin slices of wood—one on top of another. These layers are then glued together. Particleboard is made by compressing sawdust and wood chips after mixing them with a suitable resin. The compressed wood is extruded out and cut to size.

Between particleboard and plywood, the former is easier to work with, but fails miserably when it comes to strength and isn't water resistant.



There's no better feeling than fingers across polished wood